

» KINGFISHERS
AND RELATIVES

JAMAICAN TODY
Todus todus
F: Todidae

Todies are tiny, green kingfisher-like birds from the Caribbean, with a flattened bill for catching insects in flight. This species is found only in the woodlands of Jamaica.

11 cm
4½ in

bright blue back
and wings

white chest
and throat

**WHITE-THROATED
KINGFISHER**
Halcyon smyrnensis
F: Alcedinidae

Like many other tree kingfishers, this southern Asian species is a noisy bird. It has whinnying and laughter-like calls.



20 cm
8 in

**GREY-HEADED
KINGFISHER**
Halcyon leucocephala
F: Alcedinidae

Tree kingfishers are a group of mainly insect-eating forest birds. The grey-headed kingfisher is an African species that may also eat fish.

dark eye patch
contrasts with the
white head

heavy bill

29 cm
11½ in

41–47 cm
16–18½ in

12–13 cm
4¾–5 in

AFRICAN PYGMY KINGFISHER
Ispidina picta
F: Alcedinidae

This African bird belongs to a group of river kingfishers, but mainly feeds on insects so occurs away from water in woodland and savanna.

18–21 cm
7–8½ in

**YELLOW-BILLED
KINGFISHER**
Syma torotoro
F: Alcedinidae

This tree kingfisher occurs in rainforests of New Guinea and N. Australia. It feeds mainly on insects, but also eats worms and small lizards.

GREEN KINGFISHER
Chloroceryle americana
F: Alcedinidae

A tropical American bird, this water kingfisher plunge-dives for fish and aquatic insects and often perches on rocks in streambeds.

18–20 cm
7–8 in

**LAUGHING
KOOKABURRA**
Dacelo novaeguineae
F: Alcedinidae

Widespread in Australian woodland, this large tree kingfisher preys on reptiles as well as invertebrates, and has a loud chuckling call.



azure-blue
upperparts

orange
underparts

AZURE KINGFISHER
Ceyx azureus
F: Alcedinidae

Like other river kingfishers, the azure kingfisher nests in holes along riverbanks. It is found in creeks and mangroves in Australia and New Guinea.

17–19 cm
6½–7½ in



12–13 cm
4¾–5 in

LITTLE KINGFISHER
Ceyx pusillus
F: Alcedinidae

This tiny Australasian species of mangroves is a river kingfisher. It eats tiny fish, insect larvae, small crustaceans, and shrimps.



16–17 cm
6½ in

COMMON KINGFISHER
Alcedo atthis
F: Alcedinidae

Found in Eurasia and N. Africa, this bird is typical of a group of diminutive, short-tailed river kingfishers from the Old World.



28–29 cm
11–11½ in

**PIED
KINGFISHER**
Ceryle rudis
F: Alcedinidae

From Africa and S. Asia, this water kingfisher of rivers and lakes often gathers in small groups. It can hover in one spot for long periods of time.